

that you *don't have to ever pay back*. In the state of New York, you can collect up to \$405 a week. How much you receive is determined by past wages, along with the maximum amount that your state allows. Not only that, but in most states, you have a right to keep receiving that free money for 26 weeks! That's almost seven months of checks in your mailbox! And those checks come with no strings attached!

So get in touch with your state and you can start collecting too! Get more information here workforcesecurity.doleta.gov/unemploy/uifactsheet.asp.

How About Emergencies?

Sometimes the unexpected occurs, catching us off guard, forcing us to pick up the pieces and, in some cases, start all over again. But how to go about this? If you're like most Americans, you probably don't have a sufficient cushion set aside for those rainy days. If you're living paycheck to paycheck, you definitely don't have the funds to put into those last-minute emergencies that pop up from time to time. But at least there are places to turn to. If you look, you will discover that there are a number of agencies and organizations that have funds set aside to help individuals like you. If you need money for bills, for rent, for job training, for car maintenance – these places can help you!

The U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (DHHS) is a great place to start if you're looking for some extra funds. Operating in ten regions all over the country, the DHHS strives to look after the health and well-being of our nation. Being there in times of emergency is one of them. Of course, every DHHS office varies from region to region, so be sure to check what is available where you live. In the Seattle region, I know that DHHS offers three different kinds of emergency grants for an assortment of circumstances. They work with the Welfare Rights Organizing Coalition to meet needs of housing, medical care, food, and clothing, among other things. You can look into this further at www.wroc.org/factsheets/emergencygrant.htm. And, of course, if you're outside the Seattle region, simply go to the main DHHS site at www.dhhs.gov.

The Community Action Partnership is another great place to go. It heads a network of Community Action Agencies, which exist all over the country. These nonprofit organizations exist to provide support and